Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

SECOND REGULAR SESSION

RESOLUTION NO. 378

RESOLUTION DIRECTING THE COMMITTEE ON HEALTH TO CONDUCT AN INQUIRY IN AID OF LEGISLATION ON THE FRAMEWORK STRATEGY, IMPLEMENTATION OF ALL TYPES OF VACCINATION, AND THE STATUS OF EMERGING AND RE-EMERGING DISEASES IN THE BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO (BARMM)

WHEREAS, all types of vaccination will strengthen the wall of immunity of the population to prevent severe and critical diseases;

WHEREAS, the Department of Health (DOH) launched the National Immunization Program on July 12, 1976, with the assistance of the World Health Organization (WHO) and the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), which was then known as the Expanded Program on Immunization, which aims to reduce the morbidity and mortality among children against the most common vaccine-preventable diseases;

WHEREAS, the most common vaccine-preventable diseases include tuberculosis, poliomyelitis, diphtheria, tetanus, pertussis, and measles;

WHEREAS, according to the DOH, the National Immunization Program provides safe and effective vaccines against vaccine-preventable diseases for newborns, infants, older children, pregnants, and senior citizens;

WHEREAS, the DOH launched a Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19) vaccination campaign last July 26, 2022, dubbed as *"PinasLakas!"*, which aims to provide booster shots to eligible Filipinos and increase the vaccination rate among senior citizens;

WHEREAS, according to DOH Officer-in-Charge Undersecretary Maria Rosario Vergeire, the DOH will make vaccines more accessible and available in markets, places of worship, malls, transport terminals, offices, factories, plazas, or schools;

WHEREAS, there are already 71.4 million Filipinos reported to have been fully vaccinated against COVID-19 and the government needs to vaccinate more than 23 million people to achieve 50 percent (50%) booster coverage as part of the "first 100 days" of the Marcos administration;

WHEREAS, the BARMM was reported to have the lowest vaccination rate in the country;

WHEREAS, the Department of Education ordered full face-to-face classes in November of 2022, which exposed the students and pupils to the public, and as a result, to the COVID-19 virus;

WHEREAS, the Ministry of Health- BARMM must ramp up its vaccination programs to be at par with other neighboring regions;

WHEREAS, there is a need to apprise the BTA Parliament of the status of the vaccination programs in the BARMM in order to direct and/or redirect its policies for the success of vaccination programs in the region:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, To direct the Committee on Health to conduct an inquiry in aid of legislation on the framework strategy, implementation of all types of vaccination, and the status of emerging and re-emerging diseases in the BARMM.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To forward this Resolution to the Ministry of Health, for information.

ADOPTED, *Muharram* 09, 1445/July 27, 2023.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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